

CerbaSeal

Pilot Pricing Model

Research-Supported Commercial Pricing Brief

PREPARED FOR
Partner Pricing Discussion
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CerbaSeal is AI governance enforcement infrastructure. This document establishes a research-supported commercial pricing model for partner discussions, informed by adjacent market benchmarks across AI governance platforms, compliance automation, enterprise pilots, and AI implementation consulting.

RECOMMENDED FIRST COMMERCIAL PILOT

€35,000 – €75,000

Preferred anchor range: €45,000 – €60,000

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Executive Summary

CerbaSeal should not be priced as a generic SaaS tool. The most defensible pricing frame is: AI governance enforcement infrastructure + pilot implementation + evidence generation + operational support.

This is supported by the current system architecture. CerbaSeal includes a deterministic execution gate, audit/evidence pipeline, replay service, diagnostic/support services, runtime configuration, four integration starter kits, pilot configuration generation, evidence-report generation, and a Founder Independence Kit.

Recommended Commercial Bands

Band	Price Range	Applies When
Discovery / Readiness Assessment	€5,000 – €15,000	Client unclear on fit; early scoping; no confirmed workflow
Validation Pilot	€15,000 – €35,000	Synthetic/test-only; technically capable early adopter
Controlled Workflow Pilot (primary)	€35,000 – €75,000	One real or production-adjacent workflow; best first paid pilot
Preferred anchor — first pilot	€45,000 – €60,000	Starting target for a well-scoped controlled workflow pilot
Regulated Evidence Pilot	€75,000 – €150,000	Fintech, insurance, health, legal, government-adjacent
Strategic Anchor Pilot	€150,000 – €250,000+	Flagship deployment; multiple stakeholder groups; executive visibility

Engagements below €25,000 should be treated as discovery, validation, or strategic discounting — not a full operational pilot. The full pilot price reflects: one governed workflow + workflow mapping + deployment support + training + evidence package + bounded support window.

SECTION 2

Pricing Methodology

CerbaSeal does not have a direct competitor with public pricing. Pricing is therefore triangulated from five adjacent markets, each of which captures a dimension of the value CerbaSeal delivers.

Reference Category	Why Relevant to CerbaSeal
AI Governance Platforms	CerbaSeal supports runtime governance, oversight, evidence generation, and control — the core functions of this category.
Compliance Automation / GRC Platforms	CerbaSeal produces evidence and audit artifacts, though it is not a full compliance suite. GRC pricing establishes a lower bound.
Policy Enforcement Infrastructure	CerbaSeal acts as a mandatory decision gate — closer to runtime control infrastructure than documentation tooling.
Enterprise Paid Pilots / POCs	First deployments will likely be pilot-led, not self-service SaaS. Enterprise pilot pricing models are the most direct commercial parallel.
AI Consulting / Implementation	Early pilots include workflow mapping, onboarding, deployment, training, and support — implementation-weight work that must be priced accordingly.

Regulatory Context Supporting Demand

The EU AI Act and NIS2 create direct demand for governance evidence. The European Commission specifies that high-risk AI systems require logging for traceability, documentation, information to deployers, human oversight, robustness, cybersecurity, and accuracy. Article 14 of the EU AI Act centres human oversight on preventing or minimizing risks from high-risk AI systems. NIS2 increases vendor and supply-chain scrutiny, including supply-chain security and cybersecurity risk-management procedures.

Gartner projects global AI governance platform spending at \$492 million in 2026 and over \$1 billion by 2030. This positions CerbaSeal in a growing and increasingly funded budget category — not a discretionary add-on.

3.1 — AI Governance Platform Anchor

Gartner defines AI governance platforms as tools that help organizations adhere to policy, regulations, and standards across responsible AI principles, centralizing trust, risk, and security controls. These platforms are enterprise-priced and frequently use custom or contract-specific pricing.

Market research places AI governance platform spend in the tens of thousands to low six figures annually for many buyers, with enterprise deployments potentially higher. Gartner's projected market growth supports the argument that governance infrastructure is becoming a funded category.

Implication: CerbaSeal should not be priced below low-end compliance tooling when positioned as runtime enforcement and evidence infrastructure — the higher-value function within this category.

3.2 — Compliance Automation / GRC Anchor

Compliance automation platforms provide a useful lower-bound benchmark. These tools are less capable than CerbaSeal (primarily documentation and evidence collection, not runtime enforcement), which means their pricing should be treated as a floor, not a ceiling.

Vendor / Category	Reported Pricing
Vanta	Starting ~\$10,000/year; scaling to \$80,000+ at Scale/Enterprise. Median deal size ~\$19,000/year; upper-tier contracts ~\$49,000/year.
Drata	Starter packages ~\$15,000–\$25,000/year for companies with 25–75 employees. Median buyer ~\$25,000/year; reported range \$10,250–\$42,750/year.
Secureframe	Small/mid-sized companies pursuing SOC 2 alone: ~\$12,000–\$25,000/year.
SOC 2 total cost (Secureframe estimate)	Most companies spend \$10,000–\$150,000 to prepare and complete SOC 2. Full breakdown: \$80,000–\$350,000 depending on scope.

Implication: Companies already pay five figures annually for evidence automation and compliance readiness — tooling less capable than CerbaSeal. A CerbaSeal pilot should not be priced as a small add-on when it includes implementation, workflow mapping, evidence generation, and support.

3.3 — Enterprise Pilot / POC Anchor

Paid enterprise pilots are commonly priced as a fraction of expected annual contract value. A standard enterprise pilot model recommends charging 10–30% of annual contract value, with the fee credited toward the full contract on conversion.

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Implication: A meaningful CerbaSeal pilot should be paid. A free or very low-cost pilot underprices the integration, training, support, and evidence-generation work included in every Tier 1 or Tier 2 engagement.

3.4 — AI Consulting / Implementation Anchor

AI implementation work is expensive because it requires discovery, workflow mapping, deployment, integration, training, and iteration. Implementation-weight work in a CerbaSeal pilot must be priced accordingly.

Provider Type	Reported Range
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Independent AI consultants	\$150 – \$350/hour
Boutique AI consultancies	\$300 – \$600/hour
Major strategy firms	\$500 – \$1,000+/hour
AI strategy consulting (advisory source)	\$200 – \$400/hour
Full implementation support (monthly)	\$15,000 – \$25,000/month

Implication: If a CerbaSeal pilot is priced too close to ordinary SaaS, it fails to account for workflow mapping, deployment support, training, support windows, and pilot review — all of which are included in Tier 1 and Tier 2 engagements.

4.1 — Technical Proof Base

The following proof areas are directly verifiable from the repository. They reduce technical credibility risk and support the higher end of the pricing range.

Proof Area	Current Status
Test suite	391/391 passing tests · 16 test files · zero regressions
Repo audit	15/15 checks passing
Invariants	12 invariants (INV-01!INV-12) · 100% test coverage verified
Import boundaries	0 violations · 79 files scanned
Runtime dependencies	Zero runtime npm dependencies in the enforcement core
Audit trail	File-backed append-only JSONL log with SHA-256 hash chain
Replay service	Re-runs past decisions through a fresh gate instance — proves determinism
Support services	Health, integrity, diagnostics, operator action, certificate formatting

4.2 — Adoption Layer & Founder-Dependency Reduction

The adoption layer materially improves pricing confidence. Founder dependency normally suppresses pricing — repeatable onboarding and handoff materials support higher pricing by reducing perceived delivery risk.

Adoption Asset	Pricing Impact
Authority Class Registry (cerbaseal.config.json)	Reduces custom code needs for client-specific roles. No TypeScript source changes required to add new client authority classes.
Integration Starter Kits (×4)	Reduces developer onboarding and implementation uncertainty. Four working examples cover REST API, financial approval, fraud workflow, and agent integration patterns.
Workflow Config Generator (generate-pilot-config)	Reduces manual client setup effort. Client fills wizard-input.json; script generates complete 4-file pilot config package.
Pilot Evidence Package Generator (generate-evidence-report)	Reduces manual reporting effort. Reads proof-snapshot.json and produces 3-file compliance evidence package automatically.
Founder Independence Kit	Reduces perceived vendor/founder dependency. 8-phase onboarding sequence runnable by the client without requiring Jesse's involvement at each step.

The system breakdown explicitly states these five adoption priorities were built to let a client onboard, configure, pilot, and generate compliance evidence without requiring Jesse to be present at every step. This is the commercial argument for pricing at the higher end of the band.

Pilot Pricing Matrix — Tiers 0 through 4

Five commercial tiers covering the full range from early discovery through strategic anchor deployments. Tier 2 is the recommended first commercial pilot engagement.

T0	Discovery / Readiness Assessment <i>Paid qualification and scoping — not a pilot</i>
€5,000 – €15,000	
PURPOSE	Determine if the client is suitable for a CerbaSeal pilot
SCOPE	Workflow discovery, readiness assessment, deployment feasibility, compliance/evidence needs review
DEPLOYMENT	None
DURATION	1–2 weeks
CLIENT FIT	Interested but unclear fit; early-stage client; no confirmed workflow
! CONVERSION TARGET Upgrade to Tier 1 or Tier 2 pilot	

T1	Validation Pilot <i>Demonstrate enforcement and evidence model in a limited setting</i>
€15,000 – €35,000	
PURPOSE	Demonstrate CerbaSeal's enforcement and evidence model in a limited setting
SCOPE	One workflow, synthetic/test data, starter-kit integration, limited training, basic evidence review
DEPLOYMENT	Local, sandbox, or controlled non-production environment
DURATION	30–45 days
CLIENT FIT	Early adopter; technically capable; low regulatory complexity
! CONVERSION TARGET Tier 2 controlled workflow pilot or annual license	

T2	Controlled Workflow Pilot <i>PRIMARY — prove CerbaSeal against one real or production-adjacent workflow</i>
€35,000 – €75,000 <i>Preferred anchor: €45,000 – €60,000</i>	
PURPOSE	Prove CerbaSeal against one real or production-adjacent workflow
SCOPE	Workflow mapping, deployment support, runtime config, operator training, support window, evidence review
DEPLOYMENT	Client-controlled test environment, sandbox, or production-adjacent environment
DURATION	45–90 days
CLIENT FIT	Best first paid pilot — has one defined workflow and wants to prove governed execution
! CONVERSION TARGET Annual license + implementation expansion	

T3**Regulated Evidence Pilot***Governance evidence for a regulated or high-consequence workflow***€75,000 – €150,000**

PURPOSE	Demonstrate governance evidence for a regulated or high-consequence workflow
SCOPE	All of Tier 2 + deeper stakeholder training, advisory evidence review, expanded reporting, governance
DEPLOYMENT	Client-controlled or EU-hosted environment preferred
DURATION	60–120 days
CLIENT FIT	Fintech, insurance, health, legal, government-adjacent, AI compliance-sensitive environments

!' CONVERSION TARGETMulti-workflow license or strategic implementation package**T4****Strategic Anchor Pilot***Flagship deployment and referenceable commercial proof point***€150,000 – €250,000+**

PURPOSE	Build a flagship deployment and referenceable commercial proof point
SCOPE	Executive reporting, multiple stakeholder groups, expanded onboarding, formal evidence package, roadmap
DEPLOYMENT	Client-controlled or sovereign-hosted architecture
DURATION	90–180 days
CLIENT FIT	Larger regulated client or strategic reference account with high executive visibility

!' CONVERSION TARGETEnterprise license, partner expansion, or multi-client channel offering

Pricing Adjustment Matrix

6.1 — Upward Adjustments

Apply these when the engagement complexity or client profile increases delivery burden.

Factor	Adjustment	Rationale
Client-controlled deployment	+10–20%	More deployment coordination, environment review, and support complexity
Weak technical team	+15–30%	More onboarding, training, troubleshooting, and implementation burden on CerbaSeal side
Regulated industry	+15–30%	More evidence review, stakeholder scrutiny, and documentation burden
Security / procurement review	+10–25%	Requires additional materials, meetings, and response cycles
Multiple stakeholder groups	+10–25%	More training, alignment, and approval-chain mapping required
Poorly defined workflow	+10–20%	More discovery and mapping required before pilot can begin
Extended support window	+10–30%	More operational commitment and founder/partner time
Formal evidence package required	+10–20%	Increases reporting and review workload beyond standard output

6.2 — Downward Adjustments

Apply these when client profile or scope reduces delivery burden — strategic discounts should always have a clear rationale.

Factor	Adjustment	Rationale
Strong technical team	–5 to –15%	Less onboarding and support burden on CerbaSeal side
Synthetic / test-only pilot	–10 to –20%	Lower risk, less operational complexity, shorter review cycles
Strategic reference client	–10 to –20%	Discount justified only with clear reference rights or confirmed follow-on path
Clean one-workflow scope	–5 to –10%	Reduced discovery and implementation risk — faster to production
Integration pattern matches starter kit	–5 to –15%	Faster deployment and validation — lower implementation lift

SECTION 7

Annual Licensing Framework

Annual licensing should not be finalized until after at least one successful pilot. The ranges below are directional — pilot data on usage, support burden, and client ROI will produce the evidence needed to anchor these ranges with confidence.

License Type	Client Profile	Annual Range
Emerging Market License	Seed / Series A / small AI company	€25,000 – €75,000
Growth License	Series B / scale-up / mid-market	€75,000 – €250,000
Regulated Enterprise License	Financial services, insurance, healthcare, legal, government-adjacent	€250,000 – €750,000+
Strategic Platform License	Multi-workflow, multi-entity, high-consequence deployment	€750,000+

Future Quantified ROI Evidence

The strongest future pricing evidence for annual licensing would include:

- Time saved in audit preparation or workflow
- Reduction in m

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Current Pricing Constraints

Constraint 1 — No Completed Customer Pilot

This is the largest pricing limiter. Technical proof is strong and verifiable, but customer proof does not yet exist. The first successful pilot will be the single most important pricing event — it converts internal evidence into external validation.

Constraint 2 — No Quantified ROI

Until at least one pilot has been completed and measured, ROI claims are directional. The pilot design should explicitly plan for ROI data collection from day one — support hours, decision volume, approval cycle time, evidence retrieval time.

Constraint 3 — Emerging Category

CerbaSeal sits between AI governance, enforcement infrastructure, compliance evidence, and AI agent control. Buyers may require education before they understand the value category. Category education is a commercial cost that must be factored into early pilot pricing.

Constraint 4 — Not a Compliance Certification

CerbaSeal can support governance evidence, human oversight records, and traceability, but it should not be presented as AI Act compliance, GDPR compliance, SOC 2 compliance, or legal certification. This aligns with the EU AI Act's emphasis on logging, documentation, and human oversight, but does not replace legal or regulatory assessment.

Recommended Partner Language

"For a first CerbaSeal pilot, the recommended commercial range is €35,000–€75,000, with €45,000–€60,000 as the most realistic starting target for a controlled one-workflow pilot. Engagements below €25,000 should be treated as discovery or validation only, not a full operational pilot."

What This Price Reflects

The pilot price is not for standalone software. It includes:

- One engagement over the next 12 weeks in a client environment

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- Workflow mapping and approval -chain configuration
- Deployment assistance and runtime configuration
- Client and operation

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Final Summary — Recommended Commercial Positions

Stage	Recommended Price
Discovery / Readiness Assessment	€5,000 – €15,000
Validation Pilot	€15,000 – €35,000
Controlled Workflow Pilot (first commercial pilot)	€35,000 – €75,000
Preferred first-pilot anchor	€45,000 – €60,000
Regulated Evidence Pilot	€75,000 – €150,000
Strategic Anchor Pilot	€150,000 – €250,000+
Annual (Emerging Market)	€25,000 – €75,000
Annual (Growth)	€75,000 – €250,000
Annual (Regulated Enterprise)	€250,000 – €750,000+

Annual (Strategic Platform)	€750,000+
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CerbaSeal should be positioned as: AI governance enforcement infrastructure for controlled, evidence-producing, human-overseen AI-assisted workflows. Priced as: software + workflow mapping + deployment support + training + evidence package + bounded support. This is the most defensible commercial structure based on source data, system capabilities, and adjacent market benchmarks.

